

Project Planning Phase

Project Planning (Product Backlog, Sprint Planning, User Stories & Story Points)

Date	25 June 2026
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Project Name	Automated Network Request Management System
Maximum Marks	5 Marks

1. Product Backlog, Sprint Planning and Estimation

The development of the Automated Network Request Management System was planned using Agile project management principles. Initially, all project requirements were collected and organized into a Product Backlog, where each requirement was prioritized according to its business value and implementation dependency. Every major requirement was then divided into smaller user stories to simplify development, testing, and progress tracking.

The complete backlog was distributed across two development sprints, allowing each feature to be implemented in a structured and manageable manner. Story Point estimation was assigned to every user story based on the expected implementation effort, technical complexity, and development time.

The first sprint mainly focused on building the Service Portal interface, configuring the Network Request Catalog Item, implementing UI Policies, and validating user inputs. These foundational features established the user interaction layer of the application.

The second sprint concentrated on the backend implementation, including Flow Designer automation, manager approval workflow, notification services, database record creation, and dashboard development. Organizing the project in this sequence ensured that the frontend was completed before integrating the business logic and workflow automation.

This sprint-based planning approach helped maintain development consistency, improve task management, and monitor project progress effectively throughout the implementation phase.

Sprint	Functional Requirement (Epic)	User Story Number	User Story / Task	Story Points	Priority	Team Members
Sprint-1	Intake Automation	USN-1	As a user, I can open the Service Portal Catalog so that my profile data context dynamically auto-populates.	2	High	Individual Developer
Sprint-1	Intake Automation	USN-2	As a user, I can select a request type to dynamically render conditional layout fields and conceal irrelevant forms.	3	High	Individual Developer
Sprint-1	Core Orchestration	USN-3	As a system, I can hand off validated forms directly to the Flow Designer engine to execute automated conditional logic blocks.	2	Medium	Individual Developer
Sprint-2	Governance & Approvals	USN-4	As a supervisor, I can receive real-time notifications and system links to sign off or reject a pending request line.	2	High	Individual Developer
Sprint-2	Secure Ledger Write	USN-5	As a system, I can run automated sanity checks and safely inject approved transaction variables directly into u_network_database.	5	High	Individual Developer
Sprint-2	Dashboard Reporting	USN-6	As a stakeholder, I can access an operations dashboard displaying live performance widgets and overall ticket resolution metrics.	5	Low	Individual Developer

2. Burndown Chart and Progress Monitoring

A Burndown Chart was used to monitor sprint progress by comparing the remaining Story Points with the project timeline. This helped evaluate whether the planned work was being completed according to the sprint schedule and allowed early identification of development delays.

Sprint 1 Progress

Sprint 1 started with an estimated workload of 12 Story Points. During the initial days, the development focused on creating the Service Portal Catalog Item, configuring catalog variables, and retrieving logged-in employee details automatically using ServiceNow session information.

As the sprint progressed, UI Policies and mandatory field validations were implemented successfully. Since most of these activities involved standard ServiceNow configurations, development progressed smoothly without any major technical challenges. All planned user stories were completed before

the sprint deadline, resulting in zero pending Story Points and a burndown trend that closely matched the planned schedule.

Sprint 2 Progress

Sprint 2 began with 20 Story Points and primarily focused on backend automation.

The initial activities included configuring the Flow Designer workflow, implementing the manager approval process, and enabling automated notifications. During the middle phase of the sprint, additional effort was required to validate workflow conditions and verify the database insertion process for approved requests. These activities required repeated testing to ensure accurate execution of business rules.

After resolving the workflow validation issues, the remaining tasks, including dashboard creation and database integration, were completed successfully. The sprint concluded on schedule with all Story Points completed, and the burndown chart reached zero remaining effort by the final day.

3. Individual Sprint Retrospective

At the end of both sprints, an individual retrospective was conducted to review the overall development experience, identify strengths, and determine opportunities for improvement.

What Went Well

- Using built-in ServiceNow features such as the Service Catalog, Flow Designer, and UI Policies significantly reduced development time and minimized manual coding effort.
- Dividing the project into smaller user stories made implementation easier and allowed each module to be developed independently.
- Sprint planning provided better visibility into project progress and helped maintain a consistent development pace throughout the project.

- Continuous testing after each completed feature helped identify issues early, reducing rework during the final implementation phase.

Areas for Improvement

- Workflow configuration and approval automation required more testing than initially estimated, particularly while validating different approval scenarios.
- Database integration involved additional debugging to ensure that approved requests were correctly stored in the custom **u_network_database** table.
- Future sprint planning should allocate additional time for backend scripting, workflow validation, and integration testing to improve estimation accuracy.

Action Plan for the Next Development Phase

To further enhance the quality and efficiency of the project, the following improvement plans have been identified:

- Introduce automated testing during the development phase to reduce manual verification and improve workflow reliability.
- Allocate higher Story Point estimates for complex backend activities such as Flow Designer configuration, Business Rules, and database operations.
- Conduct periodic sprint review sessions to identify technical challenges early and improve project planning.
- Optimize dashboard performance and workflow execution to ensure faster processing of network requests.
- Strengthen validation mechanisms to improve data accuracy and reduce the possibility of incorrect request processing.